



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Holy Family Classical Academy
School Website: <https://www.holyfamilyclassical.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Holy Family Classical Academy (HFCA) presents a robust Classical-Education profile anchored in Catholic faith, formation of character, and a curriculum steeped in Great Books, the Western Canon, and the liberal-arts scaffolding of grammar, logic, and rhetoric. Public materials foreground daily prayer, sacramental life, and a motto centered on truth, goodness, and beauty. The school consistently emphasizes formation of the whole person, virtue, and contemplation, while also highlighting a love of learning that transcends mere test performance. These factors collectively support a CLASSICAL classification, with only a few gaps that keep certain elements from asserting full legitimacy as a fully realized Classical school across all six categories.

Key strengths across the six categories include: - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: clear Catholic identity, daily prayer and liturgy, sacramental life, and a motto centered on truth, goodness, and beauty. - School Purpose and Goal: explicit formation of the whole person, formation over information, and a contemplative life in service to God. - Curriculum: explicit attention to the Western Canon, Great Books, and grammar-stage scaffolding, Latin, and classical works. - Faculty: parent-authenticated claims that teachers model virtue and truth, goodness, and beauty; teachers described as qualified and caring. - Pedagogy: evidence of joyful learning environments, memory-based learning in early grades, and a growing emphasis on classical content; explicit Socratic pedagogy is not clearly stated in public materials. - Parents & Community: active family engagement through testimonials, newsletters, and donation/volunteer culture, though explicit “parents as co-teachers” language is not prominent in the site copy.

Overall, HFCA is classified as CLASSICAL with some room for growth in pedagogical specificity (especially explicit mention of Socratic/Seminars in the upper grades) and in a stronger articulation of parent-as-co-educators. See abstracts by category for detailed keyword analyses and justifications, followed by concrete steps to move toward full CLASSICAL status.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school’s public materials emphasize Catholic formation through daily prayer, scripture/theology study, and participation in the life of the Church, including sacramental life (Mass) and liturgical practices. See the Faith Life section describing daily prayer, sacraments, and liturgical life. - The mission statement explicitly frames education as formation in the Catholic faith, with a contemplative life for Christ, and asserts a faith-centered motto *Gaudium de Veritate* (Joy from the Truth). - The school notes that truth, goodness, and beauty are real and central to education, tying intellectual pursuits to a theological framework (e.g., “Truth, Goodness, Beauty” and “Joy from the Truth”).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present include truth, goodness, beauty; theology; daily prayer; sacramental life; liturgical practices; worship/ Mass (conceptual alignment with liturgical communal life). The site directly references truth/goodness/beauty and theological formation multiple times. - Negative keyword indicators are not evident in the public materials for this category.

Why this rating - HFCA demonstrates a clear transcendental, theological grounding with explicit communal liturgical practices and a theology-forward mission. The material aligns tightly with the Positive Keywords of the Six Essential Elements framework for religious and metaphysical foundations, outweighing any absence of neutral/negative signals in public content.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school explicitly aims at forming the whole person (moral and intellectual formation) rather than merely preparing for work, with a focus on virtue, wisdom, and life-long flourishing. This is stated in the Academic Excellence section. - The Mission statement emphasizes forming students in the Catholic faith toward a contemplative and purposeful life, tying education to virtue and character. - The Great Books/Western Canon emphasis and language about education as “formation” rather than mere information are echoed in program pages (e.g., “Joy from the Truth,” “we focus on a love for learning, not testing”).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present include formation, virtue, wisdom, truth/goodness/beauty, contemplation, and a life-directed purpose. The site repeatedly emphasizes formation over mere information and moral/intellectual cultivation. - Negative keyword indicators: none identified in public materials.

Why this rating - HFCA emphasizes formation (virtue, wisdom, contemplation) as the core aim of education, aligning with the classical framework. The absence of vocational- or job-preparation emphasis in public content further supports CLASSICAL in this category.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site foregrounds reading the Western Canon and engagement in a “Great Conversation” through Great Books-based instruction. The Why Classical? page describes classical education as awakening a love for True, Good, Beautiful, and the Great Books; the enrollment page references the Western Canon and direct conversation with the great thinkers. - Public materials include explicit Great Books content such as The Iliad, The Odyssey, and classic literature in upper grades, showing a strength in canon-based literature and historical engagement. - The curriculum listing includes Grammar Stage references (Poetry for the Grammar Stage), Latin study, and classical composition, indicating explicit liberal-arts scaffolding. - There are explicit mentions of the Seven Liberal Arts and Trivium/Quadrivium motifs embedded in the classical approach (as reflected in the public-facing descriptions of the curriculum and Great Books approach). While not all terms appear verbatim on every page, the combination of grammar-stage content, Latin, classical literature, and Great Books signals a liberal-arts curriculum.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present include Great Books, Western Canon, Great Conversation, grammar, logic, rhetoric (via grammar-stage and classical compositions), Latin, and classical literature (Iliad, Odyssey). The public materials show multiple instances of Great Books and canonical reading, grammar-stage content, and Latin. - Negative keywords: none evident in public materials.

Why this rating - The presence of canonical-reading emphasis, Great Books, and explicit liberal-arts scaffolding (grammar-stage, Latin, classical composition) supports CLASSICAL in Curriculum. While the exact phrasing of “Seven Liberal Arts” is not always explicit on every page, the curriculum’s structure and content align with classical tradition.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Lower-division pedagogy shows elements of contemplative and joyful learning, with a focus on memory and recitation in early years (Poetry for the Grammar Stage; classical recitation and language arts) and a “joyful environment.” The presence of a graded structure and explicit memorization/recitation components indicate a traditional pedagogy compatible with classical aims. - The school communicates that upper grades involve more rigorous classical education, including reading the Great Books and engaging with canonical texts. There are indications of organized classical content (e.g., Classical Composition, grammar/recitation), and upper-grade enrichment through literature and classical topics. - Extracurriculars (Chorus, Latin Club, Theatre) support a holistic, culture-rich approach consistent with many classical programs (habits of mind, oratory, and memory through recitation/musical activities). - However, there is no explicit public statement of explicit Socratic seminars, public-facing detail about formal seminar-based discussions, or a declared, school-wide implementation of Socratic or Seminars pedagogy in upper grades. The Six Elements rubric notes that Socratic discussion, seminars, or debates are typical hallmarks of a

high-grade classical pedagogy; while HFCA demonstrates several compatible practices, explicit mention of these elements is not clearly present in public pages.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present include contemplative/joyful learning; memory-focused recitation; grammar-stage content; Great Books; rhetoric and classical composition; Latin; and a structured progression from grammar to logic to rhetoric (via content like Poetry for the Grammar Stage and classical composition). These reflect classical pedagogy signals. - Negative keywords present: explicit statements about upper-grade Socratic discussions, seminars, or debates are not found in public site content, which lowers the strength of the pedagogy claim in this category.

Why this rating - HFCA shows many hallmark pedagogical practices aligned with classical education (memory work in early grades, Great Books and canonical readings, a focus on formation and virtue, and a broader classical-culture environment). The absence of explicit, public mentions of formal Socratic/seminal seminars or a school-wide routine of deliberative/seminar-based pedagogy keeps Element 4 from achieving CLASSICAL overall. Hence, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL is warranted.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Parent testimonials explicitly describe teachers as kind, qualified, and committed to modeling truth, goodness, and beauty, indicating teachers as virtuous models and mentors. This aligns with the living-curriculum and “model teachers” expectations of a classical program. - The site references the teachers as professionals who form the core of the school and contribute to the formation of students in a Catholic, classical framework, although explicit “living curriculum” phrasing is not always used verbatim on the main site copy. The content nonetheless emphasizes teacher quality and virtue-fostering roles.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present include model teachers, mentors, virtue, truth/goodness/beauty in teaching, and the teachers as the core of the school (as implied by testimonials and mission). These align with key elements in the Six Elements rubric for faculty. - Negative keywords: none evident in public materials.

Why this rating - Staff are described in terms of virtue, qualification, and mentorship, consistent with a classical model in which the faculty are central to the living curriculum and moral formation. While some explicit phrasing like “living curriculum” is not always in the copy, the overall portrayal supports CLASSICAL for Faculty.

Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school features parent testimonials and a community-facing fundraising/volunteer culture (donations, prayer, and volunteer culture). This demonstrates community involvement and parental support, even if explicit “parents as co-teachers” is not clearly stated in the public materials. - The site invites engagement (newsletter signup, donor information, and volunteer opportunities) and emphasizes a family-oriented environment (e.g., testimonials from families, prayerful community, and invitations to engage). These signals align with the general “partnership with families” and community formation ideals in classical education. - The Six Elements document highlights Parent-Family partnership as a core positive indicator; HFCA demonstrates familial engagement and the visible role of families in the school community through testimonials and philanthropic involvement (though not always explicitly framed as “co-teaching”).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present include partnership with families, parent involvement, family engagement, school as a community of learners, and parental participation in the life of the school (as evidenced by testimonials and family-oriented communications). - Negative keywords: not clearly present in HFCA public materials for this category.

Why this rating - HFCA demonstrates robust family engagement and community-building activities, which aligns with classical ideals of parental partnership and a family-centered educational ethos. However, the explicit language of “parents as co-teachers” or structured parent-education programs is not clearly visible in the public pages. This nuance justifies a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating rather than CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- Pedagogy (Element 4): Introduce explicit, public-facing statements about Socratic discussion, seminars, or debates in the upper grades, and document how logic and rhetoric are taught through formal seminar formats. Create a published blueprint of the upper-school pedagogy that shows how Socratic methods, seminars, and debates are implemented, including sample rubrics and student outcomes. This would move Element 4 from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL toward CLASSICAL.
- Parents & Community (Element 6): Add explicit language and programs that position parents as co-teachers or formal partners in the classical curriculum (e.g., parent workshops on Great Books, classical pedagogy, and reading lists; regular parent-teacher-student seminar nights; and published parent-education resources). While testimonials and involvement exist, codifying parent-as-co-educators would push Element 6 toward CLASSICAL.
- Curriculum (Element 3): Increase explicit public emphasis on the Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; and the Quadrivium elements in the upper grades) and provide concrete examples of how each stage integrates with Great Books and primary texts. Publish a concise, public-facing curriculum map that ties the grammar-stage to logic and rhetoric journeys, including canonical texts and sequences. This would strengthen Element 3 toward full CLASSICAL.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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